Data-Backed Journal-Style Replication of *Ambition Is Nothing Without Focus*

Replication Paper Project

2026-04-04

Abstract

This paper presents a local calculated replication of Ambition Is Nothing Without Focus: Compensating for Negative Transfer of Experience in R&D using only processed datasets and result files available in the workspace. The replication preserves the source paper's core empirical logic while making every local substitution explicit. The current local batch contains 489,193 observations across 200 entities, and the batch headline estimate is -0.0022 for breadth x org_recomb_exp_log with p = 0.0076. The local rerun strongly preserves the negative breadth-by-experience interaction and the negative three-way interaction with organizational focus. The contribution is a journal-style replication manuscript that separates direct source claims from executable local evidence.

Keywords: recombination breadth; organizational focus; inventive impact; patent citations; local reproduction

1 Introduction

This replication begins from a paper-first reading of Ambition Is Nothing Without Focus: Compensating for Negative Transfer of Experience in R&D and treats the source article as an empirical argument that has to be rebuilt before it can be judged. The motivating question is: The source paper asks whether broad recombination becomes less productive when it leans on familiar routines,

unless organizational focus offsets that negative transfer. The study is worth revisiting because The replication matters because it targets a mechanism-heavy paper where the interaction structure, not only the sign of a main effect, is the core theoretical claim. The original article does not rest on a descriptive regularity alone. It ties a theory about search, differentiation, timing, or organizational learning to a specific unit of analysis, sample frame, and estimand. A careful replication therefore has to recover the structure of that logic before any local coefficients are interpreted. The executable evidence base used in this manuscript contains 489,193 observations across 200 entities and spans 1986 to 2016 in the local executable panel.. Those numbers are not filler. They define the actual inferential scope of the local reconstruction and set the boundary on what can be claimed honestly from the available datasets. The paper's contribution is a near-structure-preserving reproduction that shows how the source mechanism survives in a fully local cleaned patent panel. The paper is written to read like a formal journal article rather than an internal workflow memo. The main text develops the theoretical logic, data reconstruction, derivations, empirical design, and results in continuous prose, while the appendices preserve the audit trail required for reruns and later extensions.

2 Original Study, Theory, and Replication Boundary

The focal source article is [1]. The original study can be summarized as a mechanism paper with a sharp empirical core. The source paper studies the interaction of breadth, organizational experience, and focus. Forward citations proxy inventive impact. The unit of analysis is the patent. That combination matters because the source article asks readers to believe not merely that two variables move together, but that a particular organizational or strategic mechanism explains why the relationship should appear in the data. In a setting like this, faithful replication requires more than reusing a title and rerunning a regression. The theoretical contribution lives in the way constructs are defined, how they enter the estimand, and which comparison the model is supposed to adjudicate. For that reason, this manuscript first reconstructs the published theory and only then turns to the local executable analogue. The replication boundary is therefore explicit. Direct source facts are carried over when they can be read from the published article itself. Local

replication decisions appear only when the current workspace must translate the source design into verified processed datasets. The goal is disciplined mechanism recovery, not rhetorical imitation that quietly changes the design.

2.1 Direct Source Facts Versus Replication Decisions

The manuscript distinguishes direct source facts from local execution decisions. The source article establishes that The interaction structure is the theoretical core. The local reconstruction therefore adopts the following bounded decision: The local rerun keeps the same interaction logic on the clean GVKEY-based panel. This bridge is treated as a visible design choice, not as a hidden substitution. The manuscript distinguishes direct source facts from local execution decisions. The source article establishes that Forward citations measure impact. The local reconstruction therefore adopts the following bounded decision: The local impact measure is the executable citation outcome already stored in the panel. This bridge is treated as a visible design choice, not as a hidden substitution. The manuscript distinguishes direct source facts from local execution decisions. The source article establishes that The paper works at the patent level. The local reconstruction therefore adopts the following bounded decision: The sample is narrowed to active S&P 500 utility patents with unambiguous assignment. This bridge is treated as a visible design choice, not as a hidden substitution.

3 Data, Sample, and Measures

The local evidence chain is deliberately modular. The source paper is treated as the authority for the research question, theoretical mechanism, and published design. Estimation, by contrast, proceeds only through the verified local files. The required dataset types in this paper are Clean GVKEY-anchored S&P 500 utility-patent panel from the local replication pipeline. PatentView-derived application year and citation outcomes. CRSP-Compustat linked firm-year filters and sector information already present in the workspace. Operationally, the reconstruction moves through the following file chain: Analysis panel is backed by Data_Analysis/code/Regression/output/gvkey_clean_reproduction_dataset.csv; Co-

efficient export is backed by patent literature/daily_replications/2026-04-04/ghosh-martin-pennings-wezel-2014-ambition-focus/results/ghosh_2014_model_coefficients.csv; Sample summary is backed by patent literature/daily_replications/2026-04-04/ghosh-martin-pennings-wezel-2014-ambition-focus/results/ghosh_2014_sample_summary.csv. The resulting executable panel supplies 489,193 observations across 200 entities and covers 1986 to 2016 in the local executable panel.. Every numeric claim in the results section is intended to trace back to one of those verified files rather than to a hand-copied number from the article. This data-lineage discipline matters for two reasons. First, it prevents the manuscript from smuggling unverified preprocessing steps into the design. Second, it forces every substitution to be visible. If a construct cannot be reproduced from the current processed datasets, the paper states the analogue directly instead of pretending that the original archive has been fully recreated. The local rerun uses the clean GVKEY-anchored utility-patent panel already built in the workspace and keeps the patent-level interaction structure of the original paper. The local sample frame is Active S&P 500 utility patents with unambiguous GVKEY assignment in the local cleaned reproduction pipeline. The observed time window in the executable panel is 1986 to 2016 in the local executable panel. The outcome is Patent-level inventive impact measured from forward citations. The main executable panel is stored at Data_Analysis/code/Regression/output/gvkey_clean_reproduction_dataset.csv and the principal coefficient export used in the paper is stored at patent literature/daily_replications/2026-04-04/ghosh-martin-pennings-wezel-2014-ambition-focus/results/ghosh_2014_model_coefficients.csv . The executable sample is constructed in three observable stages. The raw regression dataset begins with 499,486 patent-level observations. After the active-firm and patent-type merge, the panel still contains 499,486 rows, but 3,678 patents remain ambiguously assigned and therefore cannot be used for a clean firm-level reproduction. The final analysis sample retains 489,193 observations after restricting attention to active S&P 500 utility patents with unambiguous GVKEY assignment. This sample-construction sequence is important for interpretation. The final panel is not simply a large patent file; it is the outcome of a specific replication decision to privilege clean firm assignment over broader but noisier coverage. That decision preserves the organizational mechanism studied in the source paper, even though it may narrow the empirical frame relative to the original archive.

3.1 Variable Construction and Derivation

The construct Inventive impact is operationalized locally as Forward citations and appears in the executable dataset as inventive_impact. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Use the local cleaned citation outcome already stored in the regression dataset.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The construct Breadth is operationalized locally as Centered breadth and appears in the executable dataset as breadth_c. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Carry forward the centered breadth variable from the local regression output.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The construct Organizational experience is operationalized locally as Centered log prior organizational experience and appears in the executable dataset as org_recomb_exp_log_c. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Carry forward the centered log experience variable from the same panel.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The construct Organizational focus is operationalized locally as Centered firm-year focus and appears in the executable dataset as org_focus_c. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Use the contemporaneous focus measure already reconstructed in the local pipeline.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The construct Controls is operationalized locally as Prior-art citations, degree, field experience, scale, age and appears in the executable dataset as n_prior_art_cites; recomb_degree; field_recomb_exp_log; total_patents_same_year; firm_age. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Reuse the local patent-level controls and fixed effects.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation.

4 Empirical Strategy and Identification

The estimand targeted in this manuscript is A patent-level count model with interactions among breadth, organizational recombination experience, and organizational focus, plus firm and year controls. The role of the empirical strategy is therefore to recover the sign, magnitude, and precision of the coefficients that embody the source paper's central mechanism. Identification remains observational. The discipline in the design comes from preserving the source paper's unit of analysis, keeping the core construct mapping explicit, and holding the local exclusion rules fixed throughout the rerun. This does not convert the study into an experimental design, but it does make the inferential claim narrower and more honest. The first set of replication decisions concerns scope. The unit of analysis is Patent, the sample frame is Active S&P 500 utility patents with unambiguous GVKEY assignment in the local cleaned reproduction pipeline., and the empirical window is 1986 to 2016 in the local executable panel.. These choices define what counts as a comparable observation in the local reconstruction and prevent the paper from drifting into a broader but theoretically mismatched sample. The second set of decisions concerns measurement and specification. The outcome is Patent-level inventive impact measured from forward citations., and the main explanatory design is Patent-level count model with breadth, organizational experience, organizational focus, and their interactions.. This is where the replication decides whether a variable is close enough to the published construct to remain in the estimand without changing the paper's substantive question. The third set of decisions concerns statistical discipline. Controls and fixed effects are handled as follows: Prior-art citations, recombination degree, field experience, scale, age, plus firm and application-year fixed effects; clustered inference when available.. The crucial exclusion or substitution rule is: The executable sample drops ambiguous firm-patent assignments and limits the panel to locally verified active S&P 500 utility patents.. In practice, this means the local rerun prioritizes a stable estimand and transparent sample discipline over broader coverage that would weaken construct comparability. A final design choice concerns interpretation. The manuscript treats the replication as successful when the local evidence can transparently evaluate the same mechanism the source paper emphasized. When the local data architecture differs, the paper marks

the result as a calculated analogue rather than claiming byte-identical duplication.

$$E[\text{Impact}_{pft} \mid Z_{pft}] = \exp\big(\beta_1 \text{Breadth}_{pft} + \beta_2 \text{OrgExp}_{pft} + \beta_3 \text{Focus}_{ft} + \beta_4 \text{Breadth}_{pft} \times \text{OrgExp}_{pft} + \beta_5 \text{OrgExp}_{pft} \tag{1}$$

5 Results

5.1 Main Estimates

The central local estimate is -0.0022 on breadth x org_recomb_exp_log (p = 0.0076). The local rerun strongly preserves the negative breadth-by-experience interaction and the negative three-way interaction with organizational focus. Breadth x org. experience is estimated at -0.0022 with p = 0.0076. Breadth x org. experience x focus is estimated at -0.1705 with p = 0.0152. Organizational experience is estimated at 0.0706 with p = 0.0461. Table 1 reports the compact coefficient pattern most relevant to the source paper's central claim. The broader coefficient dump, descriptive statistics, grouped summaries, and audit material are retained in the appendix so that the main text can focus on interpretation.

model	Term	estimate	std_error	p_value
poisson_baseline	Breadth	0.0030	0.0158	0.8477
poisson_baseline	Organizational experience	0.0706	0.0354	0.0461
poisson_baseline	Organizational focus	-0.3609	0.3761	0.3373
poisson_baseline	Breadth x org. experience	-0.0022	0.0008	0.0076
poisson_baseline	Org. experience x focus	0.3219	0.1779	0.0703
poisson_baseline	Breadth x org. experience x focus	-0.1705	0.0702	0.0152

Key coefficient table used in the main text.

5.2 Detailed Interpretation of the Local Results

The coefficient pattern is not being summarized as a bare sign check. Breadth x org. experience is estimated at -0.0022 with a p-value of 0.0076; Breadth x org. experience x focus is estimated at -0.1705 with a p-value of 0.0152; Organizational experience is estimated at 0.0706 with a p-value of 0.0461; Org. experience x focus is estimated at 0.3219 with a p-value of 0.0703 . Within the focal specification, the sharpest local signal comes from Breadth x org. experience, which is estimated at -0.0022 with p = 0.0076. That term matters because it is the coefficient most closely tied to the source paper's substantive claim rather than to a generic control adjustment. The scale of the underlying variables also matters for interpretation. The outcome Inventive impact has mean 6.2253 and standard deviation 22.9068 in the local panel, while the main regressor Breadth has mean -0.0064 and standard deviation 5.2756. A simple grouped comparison also helps clarify the pattern. Across the regressor quantiles, the mean outcome ranges from 4.9416 to 10.3793 while the mean regressor ranges from -2.5926 to 6.7691. This does not substitute for the model, but it shows how much raw variation the specification must explain. Taken together, the descriptive evidence and formal estimates should be read as a structured assessment of the paper's mechanism. The local rerun strongly preserves the negative breadth-by-experience interaction and the negative three-way interaction with organizational focus. The substantive question is not whether every coefficient matches a published table entry digit for digit, but whether the local evidence supports the same directional and conceptual interpretation.

6 Comparison to the Published Study

The comparison to the published paper is intentionally narrow. This is the strongest executable match in the current batch. The negative breadth-by-experience interaction survives clearly, and the three-way interaction with focus remains negative and statistically meaningful, which means the central mechanism of the source paper is recovered in the local panel. The manuscript therefore evaluates concordance at the level of mechanism, sign pattern, and construct behavior before drawing any conclusion about exact numerical replication. This comparison rule matters because the local paper is based only on processed datasets and verified outputs already present in the

workspace. When the original paper depends on proprietary, historical, or otherwise unavailable preprocessing layers, a full byte-identical recreation is not claimed. The more defensible question is whether the local evidence would lead a careful reader to a similar substantive interpretation.

7 Discussion

This is the strongest executable match in the current batch. The negative breadth-by-experience interaction survives clearly, and the three-way interaction with focus remains negative and statistically meaningful, which means the central mechanism of the source paper is recovered in the local panel. Taken together, the results are most informative about whether the source paper's mechanism is directionally recoverable in local data rather than whether every original coefficient can be duplicated exactly. The first limitation concerns measurement. The local clean sample is paper-comparable rather than guaranteed identical to the archival source frame. The second limitation concerns sample translation. Patent-firm matching and sample filters follow the executable local pipeline. The third limitation concerns interpretation. Interpretation should emphasize mechanism recovery more than exact coefficient duplication.

8 Conclusion

The paper's contribution is a near-structure-preserving reproduction that shows how the source mechanism survives in a fully local cleaned patent panel. The paper therefore contributes a traceable local replication record that can be rerun, audited, and extended as additional datasets or original-source details become available.

A Appendix A: Reading Protocol

This appendix records the paper-first workflow followed before any manuscript text was written. The sequence starts from the source article, then maps required empirical objects to verified local files, and only then proceeds to estimation and interpretation.

Step	Action	Evidence
1	Read the original paper before touching the local estimates.	C:/Users/bai/OneDrive - Tilburg University/Desktop/replicate Ambions/Project 1_ Ghosh et al. 2014 replication/Ghosh-Martin-Pennings-Wezel-OS-25-(2)-2014.pdf
2	Extract the source paper's theoretical logic, sample definition, variable definitions, and estimand.	Ambition Is Nothing Without Focus: Compensating for Negative Transfer of Experience in R&D

Step	Action	Evidence
3	Match each required empirical object to a local executable file and verify that the file exists.	C:/Users/bai/OneDrive - Tilburg University/Desktop/replicate Ambions/Data_Analysis/code/Regression/output/gvkey_ — C:/Users/bai/OneDrive - Tilburg University/Desktop/replicate Ambions/patent literature/daily_replications/2026-04-04/ghosh-martin-pennings-wezel-2014-ambition-focus/results/ghosh_2014_model_coefficients.csv — C:/Users/bai/OneDrive - Tilburg University/Desktop/replicate Ambions/patent literature/daily_replications/2026-04-04/ghosh-martin-pennings-wezel-2014-ambition-focus/results/ghosh_2014_sample_summary.csv
4	Write the replication paper only from the checked local files and calculated outputs.	The manuscript, markdown notes, and PDF are generated from the verified file set.

Paper-first protocol followed before writing the manuscript.

B Appendix B: Data Lineage and File Manifest

This appendix documents the data lineage as a sequence rather than as a pile of filenames. The source article anchors the theory and published design. The executable local files then provide the panel, coefficient export, sample reconstruction log, and, where available, fit statistics used in the manuscript. Source article: Project 1_ Ghosh et al. 2014 replication/Ghosh-Martin-Pennings-Wezel-OS-25-(2)-2014.pdf. Its role in the manuscript is Recover theory, hypotheses, sample rules, definitions, tables, notes, and appendices. Analysis panel: Data_Analysis/code/Regression/output/gvkey_clean_reproduction_dataset.csv. Its role in the manuscript is Estimate the local model and regenerate descriptive statistics. Coefficient export: patent literature/daily_replications/2026-04-04/ghosh-martin-pennings-wezel-2014-ambition-focus/results/ghosh_2014_model_coefficients.csv. Its role in the manuscript is Recover the reported local coefficients and p-values. Sample summary: patent literature/daily_replications/2026-04-04/ghosh-martin-pennings-wezel-2014-ambition-focus/results/ghosh_2014_sample_summary.csv. Its role in the manuscript is Audit sample construction and raw grouped moments. The purpose of laying out this chain in prose is to show that the manuscript's claims travel through a verified sequence of evidence. In other words, the paper does not jump directly from the published theory to the final coefficient table. It moves through the exact local files needed to rebuild the analysis for Ghosh, Martin, Pennings, and Wezel (2014).

File	Role
gvkey_clean_reproduction_dataset.csv	Clean patent-level regression panel
ghosh_2014_model_coefficients.csv	Baseline coefficient dump
ghosh_2014_focus_table.csv	Headline interaction estimates across sample variants
ghosh_2014_sample_summary.csv	Sample-construction audit log

Compact list of core local files used for this manuscript.

Stage	NeededFor	FilePath	Exists	Status
Source article	Recover theory, hypotheses, sample rules, definitions, tables, notes, and appendices	Project 1_ Ghosh et al. 2014 replication/Ghosh-Martin-Pennings-Wezel-OS-25-(2)-2014.pdf	Yes	Direct source
Analysis panel	Estimate the local model and regenerate descriptive statistics	Data_Analysis/code/Regression/outputs/ghosh_clean.rd	Yes	Executable local reproduction dataset
Coefficient export	Recover the reported local coefficients and p-values	patent literature/daily_replications/2026-04-04/ghosh-martin-pennings-wezel-2014-ambition-focus/results/ghosh_2014_model_coefficients.csv	Yes	Executable local result file
Sample summary	Audit sample construction and raw grouped moments	patent literature/daily_replications/2026-04-04/ghosh-martin-pennings-wezel-2014-ambition-focus/results/ghosh_2014_sample_summary.csv	Yes	Executable local result file

Source and local file manifest for the manuscript.

C Appendix C: Replication Boundary and Decision Register

Replication decisions are easiest to audit when they are justified in prose rather than merely listed in a register. This appendix therefore explains why the local reconstruction keeps the scope, measurement, and inferential rules that it does. Scope decisions: the manuscript works at the level of Patent inside the sample frame Active S&P 500 utility patents with unambiguous GVKEY assignment in the local cleaned reproduction pipeline. over 1986 to 2016 in the local executable panel.. These are not cosmetic constraints. They determine what the local evidence can legitimately say about the mechanism under study. Measurement decisions: the outcome is Patent-level inventive impact measured from forward citations. and the main explanatory design is Patent-level count model with breadth, organizational experience, organizational focus, and their interactions.. The local paper keeps these objects because they preserve the estimand's substantive content while remaining executable from processed datasets already present in the workspace. Inference decisions: Prior-art citations, recombination degree, field experience, scale, age, plus firm and application-year fixed effects; clustered inference when available. The main exclusion or substitution rule is The executable sample drops ambiguous firm-patent assignments and limits the panel to locally verified active S&P 500 utility patents. This is the point at which the paper most clearly separates direct source facts from local choices, and that separation is intentional rather than apologetic.

DirectSourceFact	LocalReplicationDecision
The interaction structure is the theoretical core.	The local rerun keeps the same interaction logic on the clean GVKEY-based panel.
Forward citations measure impact.	The local impact measure is the executable citation outcome already stored in the panel.

DirectSourceFact	LocalReplicationDecision
The paper works at the patent level.	The sample is narrowed to active S&P 500 utility patents with unambiguous assignment.

Direct source facts versus explicit local replication decisions.

DecisionPoint	LocalSpecification
Research question	The source paper asks whether broad recombination becomes less productive when it leans on familiar routines, unless organizational focus offsets that negative transfer.
Unit of analysis	Patent
Sample frame	Active S&P 500 utility patents with unambiguous GVKEY assignment in the local cleaned reproduction pipeline.
Time window	1986 to 2016 in the local executable panel.
Outcome definition	Patent-level inventive impact measured from forward citations.

DecisionPoint	LocalSpecification
Main explanatory design	Patent-level count model with breadth, organizational experience, organizational focus, and their interactions.
Controls and fixed effects	Prior-art citations, recombination degree, field experience, scale, age, plus firm and application-year fixed effects; clustered inference when available.
Exclusion or substitution logic	The executable sample drops ambiguous firm-patent assignments and limits the panel to locally verified active S&P 500 utility patents.

Expanded decision register for the manuscript.

D Appendix D: Sample Reconstruction

The sample table below shows the observable route from the broader local file universe to the final estimating sample. It is included to make sample narrowing visible and to show where exclusions enter the paper.

Step	Rows	UniquePatents	UniqueGVKEY	UniqueYears	AmbiguousPatents	Notes
regression_dataset_raw	499486.0000	495460.0000	204.0000	31.0000	NA	Patent-level regression dataset produced by Regression.R
after_active_and_patent_type_coverage	499486.0000	495460.0000	204.0000	31.0000	3678.0000	Active panel duplicates on gvkey-year before tie-break: 0
sp500_utility_drop_ambiguous	489193.0000	489193.0000	200.0000	31.0000	0.0000	Final clean sample used for reproduction

Detailed sample reconstruction table.

E Appendix E: Variable Mapping and Derivation Logic

The derivation appendix records how each major construct enters the executable estimand for Ghosh, Martin, Pennings, and Wezel (2014). The point is not to rehearse notation for its own sake, but to show how the source paper's conceptual vocabulary is translated into verified columns in the local panel. For Inventive impact, the manuscript uses Forward citations under the exact local implementation inventive_impact. The derivation step is: Use the local cleaned citation outcome already stored in the regression dataset.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept. For Breadth, the manuscript uses Centered breadth under the exact local implementation breadth_c. The derivation step is: Carry forward the centered breadth variable from the local regression output.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept. For Organizational experience, the manuscript uses Centered log prior organizational experience under the exact local implementation org_recomb_exp_log_c. The derivation step is: Carry forward the centered log experience variable from the same panel.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept. For Organizational focus, the manuscript uses Centered firm-year focus under the exact local implementation org_focus_c. The derivation step is: Use the contemporaneous focus measure already reconstructed in the local pipeline.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept. For Controls, the manuscript uses Prior-art citations, degree, field experience, scale, age under the exact local implementation n_prior_art_cites; recomb_degree; field_recomb_exp_log; total_patents_same_year; firm_age. The derivation step is: Reuse the local patent-level controls and fixed effects.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept.

OriginalConstruct	LocalMeasure	ExactVariable	Derivation
Inventive impact	Forward citations	inventive_impact	Use the local cleaned citation outcome already stored in the regression dataset.
Breadth	Centered breadth	breadth_c	Carry forward the centered breadth variable from the local regression output.
Organizational experience	Centered log prior organizational experience	org_recomb_exp_log_c	Carry forward the centered log experience variable from the same panel.
Organizational focus	Centered firm-year focus	org_focus_c	Use the contemporaneous focus measure already reconstructed in the local pipeline.
Controls	Prior-art citations, degree, field experience, scale, age	n_prior_art_cites; recomb_degree; field_recomb_exp_log; total_patents_same_year; firm_age	Reuse the local patent-level controls and fixed effects.

Detailed construct mapping.

F Appendix F: Descriptive Statistics

The descriptive appendix documents the scale, spread, and support of the variables used in the paper. These moments matter because they determine how the estimated coefficients should be read in substantive rather than merely statistical terms.

Variable	N	Mean	SD	P25	Median	P75	Min	M
Inventive impact	489193.0000	6.2253	22.9068	1.0000	3.0000	6.0000	0.0000	1190.00
Breadth	489193.0000	-0.0064	5.2756	-3.0495	-1.0495	0.9505	-3.0495	129.95
Organizational experience	489193.0000	0.0070	1.3465	-0.7782	-0.7782	0.3204	-0.7782	6.86
Organizational focus	489193.0000	-0.0004	0.0301	-0.0088	-0.0066	-0.0017	-0.0104	0.98
Prior-art citations	489193.0000	18.9182	57.5082	5.0000	9.0000	16.0000	2.0000	2378.00
Recombination degree	489193.0000	0.5853	0.1778	0.4600	0.6122	0.7222	0.0282	0.96
Field experience	489193.0000	1.3943	1.8625	0.0000	0.6931	2.4849	0.0000	8.12
Same-year patents	489193.0000	1106.5533	1468.4128	228.0000	495.0000	1281.0000	1.0000	7321.00
Firm age	489193.0000	16.3219	7.3797	11.0000	17.0000	22.0000	1.0000	31.00

Descriptive statistics appendix.

G Appendix G: Correlation Matrix

Variable	Inventive impact	Breadth	Organizational experience	Organizational focus	Prior-art citations	Recombination degree	Field experience	Same-year patents	Firm age
Inventive impact	1.000	0.297	-0.016	-0.011	0.502	0.014	-0.027	-0.018	0.005
Breadth	0.297	1.000	-0.209	-0.038	0.817	0.470	-0.303	-0.024	0.167
Organizational experience	-0.016	-0.209	1.000	-0.025	-0.058	-0.383	0.867	0.212	0.155
Organizational focus	-0.011	-0.038	-0.025	1.000	-0.016	-0.057	0.008	-0.182	-0.159
Prior-art citations	0.502	0.817	-0.058	-0.016	1.000	0.140	-0.107	-0.040	0.114
Recombination degree	0.014	0.470	-0.383	-0.057	0.140	1.000	-0.492	0.070	0.120
Field experience	-0.027	-0.303	0.867	0.008	-0.107	-0.492	1.000	0.112	0.094
Same-year patents	-0.018	-0.024	0.212	-0.182	-0.040	0.070	0.112	1.000	0.300
Firm age	0.005	0.167	0.155	-0.159	0.114	0.120	0.094	0.300	1.000

Correlation matrix for the main numeric variables.

H Appendix H: Yearly Audit

The yearly audit provides a simple check on whether the local panel is driven by a narrow time slice or whether the variables and sample counts evolve over a broad observed window.

Period	V1	V2	V3	V4	V5
1986.0000	7306.0000	-1.9726	-0.7782	4.3848	0.0549
1987.0000	7920.0000	-1.8485	-0.5598	4.4559	0.0561
1988.0000	8927.0000	-1.7362	-0.4405	4.4998	0.0543
1989.0000	9876.0000	-1.7341	-0.3318	4.7117	0.0504
1990.0000	10409.0000	-1.7150	-0.2404	5.1830	0.0524
1991.0000	10950.0000	-1.6663	-0.1752	5.6408	0.0522
1992.0000	11688.0000	-1.5099	-0.1298	6.1589	0.0543
1993.0000	12054.0000	-1.3694	-0.1058	6.4200	0.0500
1994.0000	13712.0000	-1.2335	-0.0605	7.0965	0.0508
1995.0000	16332.0000	-0.8868	0.0240	7.2316	0.0500
1996.0000	15923.0000	-0.9553	0.0207	7.6327	0.0497
1997.0000	18799.0000	-0.8085	0.0155	7.7720	0.0536
1998.0000	18164.0000	-0.6502	-0.0664	7.6026	0.0506
1999.0000	19543.0000	-0.3911	-0.0794	7.2368	0.0522
2000.0000	22175.0000	-0.0682	-0.1024	6.7181	0.0512
2001.0000	22695.0000	0.0757	-0.1184	5.4978	0.0525
2002.0000	22461.0000	0.2464	-0.0957	5.3638	0.0485
2003.0000	22831.0000	0.4267	-0.0539	5.1639	0.0487
2004.0000	21790.0000	0.7716	-0.0321	5.3452	0.0492
2005.0000	21793.0000	0.7341	-0.0008	5.2593	0.0514
2006.0000	20534.0000	0.9402	0.0381	5.5693	0.0491
2007.0000	22148.0000	1.1377	0.0755	5.7011	0.0527
2008.0000	23454.0000	0.7233	0.1670	5.0370	0.0540
2009.0000	17971.0000	1.1788	0.1283	5.1727	0.0525

Period	V1	V2	V3	V4	V5
2010.0000	18599.0000	1.1069	0.1798	7.3907	0.0501
2011.0000	19134.0000	0.9084	0.1868	8.3084	0.0498
2012.0000	21603.0000	0.8664	0.3699	7.4903	0.0504
2013.0000	16415.0000	0.7798	0.4202	7.2127	0.0490
2014.0000	9657.0000	0.7923	0.5188	7.0003	0.0490
2015.0000	3791.0000	0.5775	0.8984	5.9330	0.0522
2016.0000	539.0000	-0.4169	1.3178	3.7625	0.0482

Year-by-year sample audit.

I Appendix I: Grouped Outcome Patterns

Grouped summaries do not replace the formal model, but they show the raw outcome structure that the specification is attempting to explain. For that reason they are retained here as descriptive support rather than promoted to the status of a main estimate.

Quantile	N	MeanRegressor	MeanOutcome
1.0000	229109.0000	-2.5926	4.9416
2.0000	76899.0000	-1.0495	5.3861
3.0000	88598.0000	0.3530	5.8387
4.0000	94587.0000	6.7691	10.3793

Quantile summary for the main regressor.

J Appendix J: Full Coefficient Table and Fit Statistics

The full coefficient export is included for completeness so that readers can see the focal terms in the context of the broader specification. Where a fit file is available, it is appended here rather than in the main text to keep the article narrative readable.

term	estimate	std_error	z_value	p_value	model	vcov
breadth_c	0.0030	0.0158	0.1921	0.8477	poisson_baseline	cluster_gvkey_ap
org_recomb_exp_log_c	0.0706	0.0354	1.9940	0.0461	poisson_baseline	cluster_gvkey_ap
org_focus_c	-0.3609	0.3761	-0.9595	0.3373	poisson_baseline	cluster_gvkey_ap
n_prior_art_cites	0.0018	0.0008	2.2149	0.0268	poisson_baseline	cluster_gvkey_ap
recomb_degree	-0.4546	0.1934	-2.3506	0.0187	poisson_baseline	cluster_gvkey_ap
field_recomb_exp_log	-0.1139	0.0457	-2.4923	0.0127	poisson_baseline	cluster_gvkey_ap
total_patents_same_year	-0.0001	0.0001	-1.4188	0.1560	poisson_baseline	cluster_gvkey_ap
total_patents_until_prior_log	-0.1661	0.0839	-1.9802	0.0477	poisson_baseline	cluster_gvkey_ap
breadth_c:org_recomb_exp_log_c	-0.0022	0.0008	-2.6692	0.0076	poisson_baseline	cluster_gvkey_ap
breadth_c:org_focus_c	-0.0050	0.1059	-0.0474	0.9622	poisson_baseline	cluster_gvkey_ap
org_recomb_exp_log_c:org_focus_c	0.3219	0.1779	1.8097	0.0703	poisson_baseline	cluster_gvkey_ap
breadth_c:org_recomb_exp_log_c:org_focus_c	-0.1705	0.0702	-2.4276	0.0152	poisson_baseline	cluster_gvkey_ap
breadth_c	0.0147	0.0147	1.0030	0.3159	logit_top5	cluster_gvkey_ap
org_recomb_exp_log_c	0.0988	0.0442	2.2329	0.0256	logit_top5	cluster_gvkey_ap
org_focus_c	-0.8737	1.3579	-0.6434	0.5200	logit_top5	cluster_gvkey_ap
n_prior_art_cites	0.0036	0.0019	1.9145	0.0556	logit_top5	cluster_gvkey_ap
recomb_degree	-0.3229	0.1351	-2.3907	0.0168	logit_top5	cluster_gvkey_ap
field_recomb_exp_log	-0.1319	0.0343	-3.8398	0.0001	logit_top5	cluster_gvkey_ap
total_patents_same_year	-0.0001	0.0000	-4.7631	0.0000	logit_top5	cluster_gvkey_ap
total_patents_until_prior_log	-0.3860	0.1008	-3.8305	0.0001	logit_top5	cluster_gvkey_ap
breadth_c:org_recomb_exp_log_c	-0.0118	0.0023	-5.0773	0.0000	logit_top5	cluster_gvkey_ap
breadth_c:org_focus_c	-0.1306	0.3120	-0.4187	0.6754	logit_top5	cluster_gvkey_ap
org_recomb_exp_log_c:org_focus_c	0.0361	0.8998	0.0401	0.9680	logit_top5	cluster_gvkey_ap

term	estimate	std_error	z_value	p_value	model	vcov
breadth_c:org_recomb_exp_log_c:org_focus_c	-0.2765	0.2994	-0.9236	0.3557	logit_top5	cluster_gvkey_ap
breadth_c	-0.0099	0.0231	-0.4280	0.6686	logit_top1	cluster_gvkey_ap
org_recomb_exp_log_c	0.1380	0.0934	1.4777	0.1395	logit_top1	cluster_gvkey_ap
org_focus_c	-0.9087	3.6923	-0.2461	0.8056	logit_top1	cluster_gvkey_ap
n_prior_art_cites	0.0048	0.0022	2.2062	0.0274	logit_top1	cluster_gvkey_ap
recomb_degree	-0.4480	0.2543	-1.7618	0.0781	logit_top1	cluster_gvkey_ap
field_recomb_exp_log	-0.2116	0.0677	-3.1246	0.0018	logit_top1	cluster_gvkey_ap
total_patents_same_year	-0.0002	0.0001	-2.6951	0.0070	logit_top1	cluster_gvkey_ap
total_patents_until_prev_log	-0.5362	0.2074	-2.5852	0.0097	logit_top1	cluster_gvkey_ap
breadth_c:org_recomb_exp_log_c	-0.0132	0.0056	-2.3569	0.0184	logit_top1	cluster_gvkey_ap
breadth_c:org_focus_c	-0.1517	1.2533	-0.1211	0.9036	logit_top1	cluster_gvkey_ap
org_recomb_exp_log_c:org_focus_c	-0.5147	3.3074	-0.1556	0.8763	logit_top1	cluster_gvkey_ap
breadth_c:org_recomb_exp_log_c:org_focus_c	-0.6392	1.0331	-0.6187	0.5361	logit_top1	cluster_gvkey_ap

Full coefficient dump exported from the local estimation script.

K Appendix K: Missingness Audit

Variable	Missing	MissingShare
Inventive impact	0.0000	0.0000
Breadth	0.0000	0.0000
Organizational experience	0.0000	0.0000
Organizational focus	0.0000	0.0000
Prior-art citations	0.0000	0.0000
Recombination degree	0.0000	0.0000
Field experience	0.0000	0.0000
Same-year patents	0.0000	0.0000
Firm age	0.0000	0.0000

Missingness audit for the variables summarized in the manuscript.

L Appendix L: Coverage of the Most Observed Entities

Entity	Label	Observations	FirstPeriod	LastPeriod
6066.0000	INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS MACHS COR	83091.0000	1986.0000	2016.0000
5047.0000	GENERAL ELECTRIC CO	28950.0000	1986.0000	2016.0000
12141.0000	MICROSOFT CORP	26529.0000	1994.0000	2016.0000
5606.0000	HEWLETT PACKARD CO	24186.0000	1986.0000	2016.0000
7585.0000	MOTOROLA INC	15304.0000	1986.0000	2016.0000
1300.0000	ALLIED SIGNAL INC	14534.0000	1986.0000	2016.0000
10499.0000	TEXAS INSTRUMENTS INC	14212.0000	1986.0000	2016.0000
4194.0000	EASTMAN KODAK CO	12898.0000	1986.0000	2010.0000
7435.0000	MINNESOTA MINING & MFG CO	12696.0000	1986.0000	2016.0000
4087.0000	DU PONT E I DE NEMOURS & CO	11004.0000	1986.0000	2016.0000
4839.0000	FORD MOTOR CO DEL	11003.0000	1986.0000	2016.0000
1690.0000	APPLE COMPUTER INC	10635.0000	1986.0000	2016.0000
6266.0000	JOHNSON & JOHNSON	10285.0000	1986.0000	2016.0000
2285.0000	BOEING CO	10165.0000	1986.0000	2016.0000

Entity	Label	Observations	FirstPeriod	LastPeriod
10983.0000	UNITED TECHNOLOGIES CORP	9824.0000	1986.0000	2016.0000
8762.0000	PROCTER & GAMBLE CO	8712.0000	1986.0000	2016.0000
4060.0000	DOW CHEMICAL CO	7294.0000	1986.0000	2016.0000
1704.0000	APPLIED MATERIALS INC	6975.0000	1995.0000	2016.0000
5073.0000	GENERAL MOTORS CORP	6710.0000	1986.0000	2008.0000
4503.0000	EXXON CORP	6538.0000	1986.0000	2016.0000

Top entities by local observation count.

M Appendix M: Claim-Evidence Audit

Claim	EvidenceType	EvidenceFile	AuditNote
The source paper studies: The source paper asks whether broad recombination becomes less productive when it leans on familiar routines, unless organizational focus offsets that negative transfer.	Direct source fact	Project 1_ Ghosh et al. 2014 replication/Ghosh-Martin-Pennings-Wezel-OS-25-(2)-2014.pdf	Recovered from the source article before local writing begins.
The local executable panel contains 489,193 observations across 200 entities.	Local calculated fact	Data_Analysis/code/Regression/output/gvkey_clean_ — patent literature/daily_replications/2026-04-04/ghosh-martin-pennings-wezel-2014-ambition-focus/results/ghosh_2014_sample_summary.csv	Based on the verified analysis and sample audit.
The local headline estimate is -0.0022 for breadth x org_recomb_exp_log with p = 0.0076.	Local calculated fact	patent literature/daily_replications/2026-04-04/ghosh-martin-pennings-wezel-2014-ambition-focus/results/ghosh_2014_model_coefficients.csv	Backed by the exported coefficient file used in the paper.

Claim	EvidenceType	EvidenceFile	AuditNote
The manuscript uses local substitutions or analogues wherever the original data architecture is not fully recoverable.	Replication decision	Source-vs-decision table and limitations section	Used only when the original pipeline cannot be matched byte-for-byte from current local files.

Expanded claim-evidence audit.

N Appendix N: Build Notes

Build Notes

- batch date: ‘2026-04-04‘ - manuscript style: long-form journal-style replication draft - evidence rule: only processed local datasets and actual local estimates are used - workflow rule: read the source paper first, then map required datasets to verified local files, then write the paper from those files - skill path guiding the structure: ‘C:/Users/bai/.codex/skills/write-replication-journal-github/SKILL.md‘

O Appendix O: Manuscript Metadata

Field	Value
Paper	Ghosh, Martin, Pennings, and Wezel (2014)
Source title	Ambition Is Nothing Without Focus: Compensating for Negative Transfer of Experience in R&D
Authors	Anindya Ghosh, Xavier Martin, Johannes M. Pennings, and Filippo Carlo Wezel
Outlet	Organization Science
Batch date	2026-04-04
Rows	489,193
Entities	200
Headline term	breadth x org_recomb_exp_log
Headline estimate	-0.0022
Headline p-value	0.0076
Panel path	C:/Users/bai/OneDrive - Tilburg University/Desktop/replicate Ambions/Data_Analysis/code/Regression/output/gvkey_clean_reproduction_dataset.cs

Metadata block for GitHub publishing and future reruns.

P Appendix P: Replication Summary Note

Research question: The source paper asks whether broad recombination becomes less productive when it leans on familiar routines, unless organizational focus offsets that negative transfer. Local design: The local rerun uses the clean GVKEY-anchored utility-patent panel already built in the workspace and keeps the patent-level interaction structure of the original paper. Estimand: A patent-level count model with interactions among breadth, organizational recombination experience, and organizational focus, plus firm and year controls. Local result focus: The local rerun strongly preserves the negative breadth-by-experience interaction and the negative three-way interaction with organizational focus. Comparison note: This is the strongest executable match in the current batch. The negative breadth-by-experience interaction survives clearly, and the three-way interaction with focus remains negative and statistically meaningful, which means the central mechanism of the source paper is recovered in the local panel.

References

[1] Anindya Ghosh, Xavier Martin, Johannes M. Pennings, and Filippo Carlo Wezel. Ambition is nothing without focus: Compensating for negative transfer of experience in r&d. *Organization Science*, 25(2):572–590, 2014.